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Europe Branded Consumer Goods: Luxury Goods: Watches round-up June 2026: Swiss Watch Exports +11% y/y; latest industry news wrap

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In June, Swiss watch exports increased by 11.2% YoY (post +0.4% YoY in May) vs. -5.6% in June 2025. In absolute terms, Swiss watch exports were CHF 2.4bn (vs. CHF 2.15n in June 2025).

GS View: The key takeaways from the May release remain the continued **volatility in import numbers for Mainland China and Hong Kong,** and **for the US,** although induced by tariffs. We note exports to **Mainland China** decreased -17% in June and overall by -9% in Q2, following -1% in Q1, while **HK** was positive at +7% in June and overall at +8% in Q2, following -1% in Q1. The positive numbers in Hong Kong reflect increased tourism and shopping offshore from Chinese consumers, while numbers in Mainland China continue to show weakness although we note a sequential improvement on a 1 and 2y stack. Overall, YTD exports to Mainland China stand at -5% while HK is up +3%, which we look at in the context of more recent luxury peer commentary around continued stabilization in Mainland China with an improvement in offshore spending. Consistent with this, Richemont, which reported on July 15, commented on the return to growth of the Chinese cluster driven by offshore spending in the region and Swatch reported +9% cFX growth in Greater China for 1H26 post negative performance in FY25 and as management had commented on a return to growth from 4Q25. We also note **UK** imports are up 6% YTD which we view positively, particularly in the context of WOSG commenting on improving trends and positive momentum in key flagship locations a more volatile period (see FY26 results 16th July).

By region for the largest markets: The US, the largest market, saw exports increase by +13% in June to CHF 349mn, post +12% in May and -56% in April, and continues to be impacted by a strong base effect due to the volatility in shipments following the implementation (April and August 2025) and more recent decrease in tariffs (November 2025).

Mainland China saw exports to the region decrease -17% in June post a decrease of -21% in May, an increase of +17% in April, and an overall -1% in Q1. Exports to **Hong Kong** increased +7% following +3% in May and -1% in Q1.

Across other key Asian markets, results were strong, with **Japan** at +9%, **Singapore** at +7% and **South Korea** at +25%.

Europe saw mixed performance in June, with the **UK** up +12% (post +25% in May, -10% in April and overall +2% in Q1) in contrast to **Italy** -21%, **Germany** -11% and **Spain -35**%. We note **France** (+104%) continues to be impacted by re-exports to other destinations.

The **UAE** market increased +20% in June (post -13.5% in May, -9.5% in April and +5% in Q1) likely rebounding post the Middle East conflict's initial impact.

By price bracket: By volume, the **second-to-lowest price category (CHF 200–500) outperformed** at +51% and the **highest (>CHF 3,000) and lowest (CHF <200) price segments** were positive at +12% and +7% respectively for the month of June while the **mid-price (CHF 500–3,000)** underperformed at -1%. By value terms, similarly the **second lowest price category (CHF 200–500)** outperformed at +54% and the **highest (>CHF 3,000) and lowest (CHF <200) price segments** were positive at +14% and +10% respectively for the month of June, while the **mid-price (CHF 500–3,000)** segment underperformed at -5%.

Recent industry news and data / Read-across

Richemont reported a stronger start to FY27, with Specialist Watchmakers returning to growth (+8% at constant currency) led by the Vacheron Constantin, Jaeger-LeCoultre and A. Lange & Söhne brands. Growth was strongest in the Americas and Japan, while Asia Pacific remained broadly stable despite continued weakness in Mainland China, Hong Kong and Macau. The group also highlighted double-digit growth at Watchfinder & Co., reinforcing positive momentum in the pre-owned watch market. Although jewellery maisons continued to significantly outperform watches, the results suggest an improving demand backdrop for luxury watches and continued strength in the secondary market.

US-based luxury watch marketplace Bezel reported that 38% of Rolex watches submitted to its marketplace fail authentication checks, the highest rejection rate among major brands and as Rolex remains the platform's largest brand, accounting for 28% of sales. The report highlights the growing importance of authentication and trust in the expanding pre-owned watch market, which now features over $1bn of active listings. In our view, this reinforces the value of Watches of Switzerland's Certified Pre-Owned (CPO) offering, which benefits from dedicated authentication, servicing and certification capabilities, helping build customer trust while attracting new clients to the group.

Last week, Watches of Switzerland reported FY26 results (see July-16), where the company reiterated its FY27 outlook. Further, management hosted an investor presentation highlighting significant growth opportunities across the US, CPO, jewellery and ecommerce, while reiterating its confidence in resilient luxury watch demand and healthy wait-list dynamics. Days before the reporting date, Reuters reported that Watches of Switzerland recently held discussions with potential private equity and strategic buyers, although no formal offer was made, with management refusing to make any further comments on the headline. We continue to see **Watches of Switzerland** (Buy; last close 770p) as an attractive way to gain exposure to the primary and secondary market for high-end watches as well as the jewellery market, with Rolex CPO and Roberto Coin emerging as key growth drivers, and the former now the group's second-largest brand after primary Rolex sales. Overall, we continue to expect WOSG to benefit from its strong position in the market in both the UK and the US, with support from wait-listed products and an attractive cohort mix with multiple growth levers across different segments.

Lastly, Swatch (not covered) released 1H26 results this morning, with Watches & Jewellery growing +9.5% cFX in 1H26, with particular strength in the United States (+27%) and Japan (+20%). Greater China continued to improve with +9% cFX in 1H26, post positive performance in 4Q25 and -10% cFx in 3Q25. Omega grew +20% cFX in Retail, and Harry Winston recorded +20% in Greater China, while Longines, Tissot and Hamilton grew double-digit through the half reflecting market share gains in entry-level and mid-range brands.

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